

Identify gaslighting behaviors from bosses and documented response/coping strategies — Action Checklist

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IDENTIFY THE PATTERNS

- ☐ **Identify the Patterns:** Notice when your boss restates your ideas in meetings with different wording and no credit, because this meeting mirroring is designed to make your contributions disappear from group memory.
- ☐ **Identify the Patterns:** Track hallway and one-on-one conversations where you proposed solutions that your boss later presented to leadership without mentioning you, because these deniable moments are the foundation of gaslighting.
- ☐ **Identify the Patterns:** Watch for the revision erasure pattern where your initial work gets modified and then presented as your boss's contribution, because this trains you to stop claiming your own thinking over time.
- ☐ **Identify the Patterns:** Recognize retroactive attribution when something you created months ago resurfaces and your boss implies they were the originator, because this pattern makes you doubt what you actually remember creating.

DOCUMENT YOUR EVIDENCE

- ☐ **Document Your Evidence:** Start a dated log of every instance where you feel your contributions were taken or your memory was questioned, because written records protect you from the self-doubt gaslighters deliberately create.
- ☐ **Document Your Evidence:** Record not just what happened but who witnessed it, what was said verbatim, and your emotional reaction, because multi-layered documentation is harder to dismiss or minimize later.
- ☐ **Document Your Evidence:** Keep your documentation factual and free of editorializing, because objective records are more credible if you need to escalate, involve HR, or seek outside support.
- ☐ **Document Your Evidence:** Identify your three most recent examples of credit theft and write them out completely with specific dates and witnesses, because having concrete evidence prevents the "maybe I'm overreacting" narrative.

RESPOND WITH STRATEGY

- ☐ **Respond With Strategy:** Decide what outcome you want before addressing an issue, because knowing whether you want resolution or a record determines whether you speak privately or create documentation.
 - ☐ **Respond With Strategy:** Raise concerns in written channels like email whenever possible instead of verbal conversations, because written records are harder for gaslighters to deny or reframe later.
 - ☐ **Respond With Strategy:** Seek corroboration from colleagues who witnessed the same behaviors, because isolated experiences are easier to dismiss than patterns confirmed by multiple people.
 - ☐ **Respond With Strategy:** Begin planning your exit if patterns persist despite your documentation efforts, because staying in a gaslighting dynamic causes cumulative psychological harm that worsens over time.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.